

Developing Expository Paragraphs

Writing Paragraphs

What do you notice?

Going to college can be expensive. College tuition and room and board can cost anywhere from \$2,000 to more than \$10,000 per semester, but other expenses make going to college even more expensive. For example, books typically cost between \$100 and \$500 each term. Materials are also very expensive. Paper, notebooks, writing utensils, and other supplies required often cost more at the college bookstore than at any local discount department store. For instance, a package of notepaper costing \$2 at a discount store might cost \$5 at a college bookstore. In addition, there are all kinds of special fees added onto the bill at registration time. A college student might have to pay a \$50 insurance fee, a \$20 activity fee, a \$15 fee to the student government association and anywhere from \$100 to \$500 for parking. There is another fee if a student decides to add or drop classes after registration. The fees required to attend college never seem to end.

(Topic Sentence) Going to college can be expensive. **(Restriction)**

College tuition and room and board can cost anywhere from \$2,000 to more than \$10,000 per semester, but other expenses make going to college even more expensive. **(illustrations)**

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Expository Writing

What is its purpose?

To share information

What does it look like?

Can be in the form of a paragraph or an essay

Expository Writing

Where does it come from?

Expository comes from the word *expose*.

What does it do?

Expository writing *exposes*, or makes clear and explains.

Where is it found?

When you read any newspaper, magazine article, textbook, or other type of publication, you are reading expository writing.

What is it made up of?

An *expository paragraph* consists of a topic sentence, body, and closing sentence.

Expository Paragraph

- group of sentences dealing with one topic
- Indent first line a few spaces
- Has *unity*, *coherence*, & *development*
 - Unity- only 1 idea discussed
 - Coherence- sentences arranged logically and connected by transitions, pronouns, and repetition of important words.
 - Development- enough specific information given to make the idea completely understandable.

Expository Paragraph Patterns

Using a Pattern

A **basic pattern** can be used to make sure you have the **necessary elements** in your paragraphs.

T(R)IC Pattern

T(R)IC: Topic-(Restriction)-Illustration-
Conclusion

T(R)IC is an **acronym** that represents the “Trick” to writing a quality paragraph. Each letter represents one of the necessary elements. However, the “R” can be separate or part of the “T.” That is the reason for the parentheses.

“T” of T(R)IC

The “T” represents the *topic sentence*.

The *topic sentence* is a sentence that states the topic, or main idea, of the paragraph. It lets the reader know what the paragraph will be about.

“T” of T(R)IC

The “T” can be stand alone or include the “R.”

Topic sentence alone- general statement of the topic. Needs to be followed by a “R” sentence.

Topic sentence including “R”- already limited.

“T” alone of T(R)IC

Topic sentence alone- In this choice, the general statement of the topic.

EX: Prehistoric monuments have fascinated travelers in Europe for hundreds of years.

This will need another sentence after it that states the restriction (R).

“T” alone of T(R)IC

Topic sentence alone - In this choice, the general statement of the topic will need another sentence after it that states the restriction (R).

EX: Prehistoric monuments have fascinated travelers in Europe for hundreds of years. The most often visited prehistoric monument in England is Stonehenge, dating from the Stone Age, about 2000 B.C.

“T” alone of T(R)IC

EX: Prehistoric monuments have fascinated travelers in Europe for hundreds of years. The most often visited prehistoric monument in England is Stonehenge, dating from the Stone Age, about 2000 B.C.

The “T” alone gives the general statement of the topic: prehistoric monuments in Europe. The (R) sentence narrows the topic from *all* monuments in *all of Europe* to just *one* monument (Stonehenge) in *one* country (England).

“(R)” of T(R)IC

The “(R)” represents the *restriction sentence*.

The *restriction sentence* can be a separate sentence that limits the topic by making the subject narrower or more focused than in the topic sentence

or

It can be included in the “T” (topic sentence) so the topic sentence *is* narrowed and limited.

“(R)” of T(R)IC *separate*

As we saw, the *restriction sentence* can be a separate sentence that **limits the topic by making the subject narrower or more focused than in the topic sentence.**

EX: Prehistoric monuments have fascinated travelers in Europe for hundreds of years. **The most often visited prehistoric monument in England is Stonehenge, dating from the Stone Age, about 2000 B.C.**

“(R)” of T(R)IC *included*

The *restriction sentence* can be included in the “T” (topic sentence). This means the topic sentence is already limited (restricted).

EX: One of the most remarkable things about Stonehenge is the way its builders were able to carry out difficult transportation and engineering feats with primitive tools.

Assignment:

Demonstrate an understanding of the Topic Sentence and Restriction sentence, both being used together and separate. Select a subject that interests you and create quality examples of both forms (used together and separate) for your subject. You need to end up with an example of your subject with a general topic sentence followed by a narrowing restriction sentence (separate example) and another example of the Topic-Restriction in one limited topic sentence (together example). Be ready to share.

“I” of T(R)IC

The “I” represents the *illustration sentences*.

The *illustration sentences* are the body (middle part) of the paragraph. They are the supporting detail sentences that explain the topic and show or give specific information about the topic.

T(R)IC Paragraph example:

Animals protect themselves in amazing ways. One common way animals protect themselves is by changing color to blend in with their environment. A good example of this is the snowshoe rabbit. This rabbit turns from brown in summer to white in winter. Its change in color makes it hard for predators to see the rabbit in dry summer grass and winter snow. Cuttlefish also change color to blend with their surroundings. Come dusk, the cuttlefish turn from colorful billboards into masters of disguise, retiring to the seafloor, where they use their extraordinary color manipulation to hide from predators such as dolphins. Without the ability to change color, some species of animals would probably be extinct by now.

Illustration sentences explain the topic and develop the paragraph in four specific ways:

- Using Facts
- Using Examples
- Using Reasons
- Using Incidents

Illustration sentences can explain the topic and develop the paragraph using **Facts**

A paragraph developed mainly by **facts** answers the questions *who? what? when? where?* and *why?*

Example sentence about George Washington:

George Washington (*who?*) was named head of the Continental Army (*what?*) in 1775 (*when?*) in Philadelphia (*where?*) by an act of the Second Continental Congress (*how?*).

Illustration sentences using Facts

Readers are more likely to understand your idea if you use facts in your illustration sentences. A *fact* is something that can be proven true. Facts can be checked and verified.

It is a *fact* that John F. Kennedy was the President of the United States from 1961 to 1963. You can verify this fact in many ways, such as talk to people who knew him, you can see and hear him on video footage, and you can read about him in books and magazines.

Illustration sentences using Facts

Assignment 1: With a partner, read the model paragraph “Mary McLeod Bethune” that was developed with facts. Then, answer the *Think and Discuss* questions.

Illustration sentences using Facts

Assignment 2: On your own, complete Writing
Practice 4: *Developing a Paragraph with Facts*

Illustration sentences can explain the topic and develop the paragraph using **Examples**

An example is one item taken from a larger group or concept. The blue chair in your living room is an **example** of the furniture in your house. The Xbox 360 is an **example** of a gaming system. The smile on Jim's face when he receives a new bike for his birthday is an **example** of happiness.

A paragraph developed mainly by **examples answers *who specifically? what specifically? when specifically? where specifically? and how specifically?*** The “specifically” part comes from clear and relevant details about the example.

Illustration sentences using **Examples**

A topic sentence about a healthy eating (*generalization*) could be illustrated with sentences about eating lots of fruits and vegetables (*specific*), eat more fish (*specific*), cut down saturated fats and sugar (*specific*), and consume less salt (*specific*).

Illustration sentences using Examples

Assignment 1: With a partner, read the model paragraph “Solar Energy” that was developed by examples and the explanation that follows it.

Illustration sentences using Examples

Assignment 2: On your own, complete Writing
Practice 3: *Developing a Paragraph with
Examples*

Illustration sentences can explain the topic and develop the paragraph using **Reasons**

A paragraph developed mainly by **reasons** answers the question *why*?

Many topic sentences give the writer's personal opinion. For example, you could write the topic sentence *Today's movies are better than ever*. This topic sentence states an opinion that may or may not be shared by others. **If you wish for others to accept your opinion, you will have to explain why you think as you do.** Reasons answer the question *why*?

Illustration sentences using Reasons

Your opinion is more valuable to others if it is based on evidence. Reasons supported by evidence may contain facts, statements of authorities or experts, or your observations and experience.

Reasons can't just be stated, but need to be supported by details.

Illustration sentences using Reasons

EX: (*topic sentence*) Teenagers too young to drive automobiles should have a moped. (*Why?*) Mopeds are economical, give teenagers practice in observing laws, and relieve parents of the need to drive their teenagers to so many places. [*This illustration sentence gives reasons for the assertion made in the topic sentence*]

Illustration sentences using Reasons

Assignment 1: With a partner, read the model paragraph “Television Is Too Violent” that was developed with reasons and complete the *Think and Discuss* questions.

Illustration sentences using Reasons

Assignment 2: On your own, complete Writing Practice 5: *Developing a Paragraph with Reasons*

Illustration sentences can explain the topic and develop the paragraph using Incidents

One way to illustrate your topic sentence and capture your reader's attention is to develop your paragraph by telling a brief story, or an incident. An incident may be something that happened to you, you read about, or heard about.

EX: (*topic sentence*) In Gettysburg, Pennsylvania, on July 1st to 3rd, 1863, one of the most decisive battles of the War Between the States was fought. (*Incident*) Then you could illustrate your paragraph with sentences that tell in chronological order the story of what happened each of the three days of the battle.

Illustration sentences using Incidents

Assignment 1: With a partner, read the model paragraph “Animal with Frightening Strength” that was developed with incidents and complete the *Think and Discuss* questions.

Illustration sentences using Incidents

Assignment 2: With a partner, complete a third incident that would work in the model paragraph “Animal with Frightening Strength.”

Illustration sentences using Incidents

Assignment 3: On your own, complete Writing Practice 6: *Writing a Paragraph with Incidents*.